

Tanuja Paunikar

Product Designer

Pune, India • Remote preferred, open to relocation for the right role • Available immediately

Product designer with 10+ years, from studio client work to leading design for three SaaS products used across 3M+ sites. I led the function, not just the files, direction set with the founder, the quality bar held across releases, and designers mentored along the way. My work does not end in Figma; for the last two years I have shipped a few products by directing AI coding agents inside a locked design system, one of them through App Review, one open source.

[Email](#) [Portfolio](#) [LinkedIn](#) [Twitter](#)

What I bring

End-to-end product design. First idea to shipped, with the process fitted to the problem: research first, a few directions to compare, or one final design when the call is clear. Prototypes get built in code so stakeholders try the real thing, then go out for feedback or straight to production.

User research. Interviews, usability tests, support tickets, reviews, and funnel analytics, before any design starts. All of it shows up in the work.

Design systems. A decade of them, studio clients across product, marketing, and brand, one system shared by three SaaS products that engineers chose to use, and lately in code so AI tools build inside the rules. Knowing when to follow, bend, or grow one is the job.

AI-native workflow. Designed in Figma, built with Claude Code, Codex, and Cursor. System first so everything stays consistent, every output checked before it ships. Batch, an open source tool that lets AI agents work from notes, came out of this workflow.

Accessibility & platforms. The responsive web and iPhone, working for everyone: accessible by default, careful type, motion that calms down when asked.

Leadership & collaboration. Led design for three brands, founder-direct. Quality held on 60+ releases, designers coached through critique, four years async with a US team. Ready to manage one.

Freelance & Independent Practice

Product Designer and Builder

Feb 2020 to present · Remote, India

Product design practice, first alongside full-time work and full-time since 2025. Engagements through referrals, from client dashboards and apps to complete products designed and shipped end to end.

- **Orime** (2026, live on the App Store): native iOS rewards app. Decision-first home that shows only what needs a decision now, points-versus-cash slider with earn-back shown up front, automatic right-card recommendation. SwiftUI, design system encoded in the codebase, through App Review.
- **HealthFirst** (2026): fully built healthcare web app on React and Laravel. Multi-role permissions, patient intake, multi-member profiles, admin review, and insurance pre-authorization, accessible on a documented component system.
- **Batch** (2026, open source, MIT): macOS app for AI-assisted work in React, TypeScript, and Tauri, with an MCP server so coding agents act on notes, 74 tests, signed and notarized releases.
- Client work across finance dashboards, sports platforms, reading apps, and video archives, shipped as the only designer, including empty states, error flows, and store assets, with complex role-based workflows modelled into clear interfaces.

Awesome Motive

UI/UX Designer (AIOSEO, LowFruits, SEOBoost)

Apr 2021 to Dec 2025 · Remote, US-based, globally distributed team

Only designer for three B2B SaaS products on a platform used across 3M+ sites by small businesses, agencies, and developers. Reported directly to the founder, no PM in between, working with engineering, content, and growth.

- Built one design system from zero, tokens, components, variants, and documentation, extended it to both acquisitions, and got engineers with no time for a system to adopt it.
- Designed the full self-serve funnel, install, onboarding, configuration, upgrade, and checkout, with no sales call, and iterated it on funnel data with the growth team.
- Designed flagship features: TruSEO in-context content scoring, an AI assistant for titles and FAQs, a visual schema builder for structured data, Search Console reporting, site audit and monitoring dashboards, and SEOBoost's data-heavy keyword research UX.
- Designed marketing and growth surfaces, landing, pricing, lifecycle, and launch pages, in step with product releases.
- Ran user research myself, interviews, usability testing, support-ticket and review mining, and funnel analysis, and turned findings into shipped work. Design QA and sign-off on 60+ releases.
- Contributed to growth from 2M to 3M+ installs, with the product holding 4.7/5 across 5,000+ reviews. Mentored designers across brands through structured critique.

Bokaap Design

UI/UX Designer

Feb 2016 to Apr 2021 · Mumbai, on-site

Design studio, Mumbai. Led product, web, and brand engagements for global early and growth-stage clients, owning design end to end and shaping strategy with founders.

- Led design end to end on Sevasadan, FootageFarm, GEPL Capital, and Itara among others, from discovery and user research through information architecture, UI, prototyping, and launch.
- Shaped product strategy with founders and PMs: scoped MVPs, prioritised roadmaps by user impact, and defined what shipped in v1 versus later.
- Built design systems adopted across product, marketing, and brand, cutting handoff time and unifying every touchpoint into one experience.
- Ran usability testing, stakeholder interviews, and client workshops, presenting work from ambiguous first brief to final delivery.
- Partnered with engineering through implementation and design QA, owning pixel-level fidelity and accessibility from Figma to production.

How I work with AI

I lock the design system first, then direct Claude Code, Codex, and Cursor to build one flow at a time, reviewing every output before it moves on. The tools produce, I decide, and a working prototype is on real data in days, not weeks.

Tools

Design Figma, expert level, components, variables, Dev Mode, prototyping, Adobe CS. **Build** Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, GitHub. **Motion** GSAP, Motion. **Motion** GSAP, Jitter, Higgs. **Collaboration** Jira, Notion, Slack, Granola, Linear, Wipr Flow, Google Workspace.

I try every new design tool the week it ships, Rive, Spline, Paper, Reve, Claude Design included, and keep what earns its place.

Get in Touch

Looking for full-time, remote work at a place where design owns outcomes, not just deliverables. Strong bias for product teams building something genuinely ambitious.

Portfolio: tanujapaunika.co ↗

Email: tanuja.paunika@gmail.com ↗

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/tanuja-paunika-9a64182a0/> ↗

Twitter: <https://x.com/tanujaapaunika> ↗